

Chapter 40-1

After the burning heat swept through her entire body, what she could feel next was intense pain.

This kind of pain seemed to grow from between her bones, leaving her at a loss for what to do, unable to pinpoint a specific location where it hurt.

She just felt that all her thoughts were being imprisoned at this moment.

There was only one thought in her mind—she wanted this pain to stop, no matter what method was used, no matter what price had to be paid.

She didn't know how much time had passed when the pain finally slowly disappeared.

And she was like someone who had been fished out of water, her whole body soaked with sweat.

Only then did Yin Lingzhu understand what a susceptible period¹ without suppressants meant for an Alpha.

The burning heat in her body subsided, and the wet clothes clung tightly to her skin, bringing a sense of coolness.

Yin Lingzhu couldn't stand it. She got out of bed and carefully examined the hospital room she was in.

Fortunately, this hospital room had a bathroom.

After washing, Yin Lingzhu changed into a fresh set of patient clothes.

Now she looked like she was in very good spirits, not at all like someone who was sick.

The pain from just now seemed like it was only a dream.

Yin Lingzhu thought for a long time. She now had only two solutions.

One was to endure it herself.

One was to find a way to get suppressants.

She decisively abandoned the first option.

She couldn't endure this kind of bone-deep pain.

So it was the second option.

Yin Lingzhu made up her mind, opened her phone, and found that number.

Looking at the name displayed, she hesitated for a second, then pressed the call button.

[Ming Qingyun]

The phone was immediately answered, and Ming Qingyun's voice came through the speaker.

Yin Lingzhu felt a bit embarrassed, but she had no other choice right now.

"Qingyun, do you have S-level Alpha suppressants?" Yin Lingzhu's voice was a bit stuttering.

Ming Qingyun heard her question, "Of course."

"Then can I buy some from you?" Seeing her respond so confidently, Yin Lingzhu couldn't suppress her joy and hurriedly said.

There was no sound from the other end for a long time, so long that Yin Lingzhu thought Ming Qingyun had hung up the phone.

In Yin Lingzhu's anxious waiting, Ming Qingyun spoke.

"Sure." She paused slightly, "But the price is very expensive."

Yin Lingzhu's heart rose high with her pause, then fell again after hearing her subsequent words.

She still had quite a lot of money now.

"Tell me, how much?"

Yin Lingzhu could hear Ming Qingyun's light laughter through the phone.

"Five hundred thousand, per bottle."

Yin Lingzhu's confidence shattered into many pieces the moment Ming Qingyun spoke.

To get through one susceptible period, she needed at least three bottles of suppressants.

Yin Lingzhu secretly calculated the money she had saved up until now.

Before the team disbanded, they had participated in several programs.

The money Yin Lingzhu received in total was around two million.

After necessary expenses, the money Yin Lingzhu had available to use now was exactly one million five hundred thousand.

Yin Lingzhu calculated.

"Okay, just give me your account number."

The next morning, Ming Qingyun was discharged from the hospital.

The hospitalization fees were quite expensive too.

Yin Lingzhu looked at the bill and felt a bit of heartache.

Half a year of hard work, all for nothing, Yin Lingzhu thought painfully.

Yin Lingzhu returned to the hotel and lay listlessly on the bed.

Fortunately, her hotel was paid monthly, and she had already paid for this month.

At eight o'clock that evening, Ming Qingyun knocked on Yin Lingzhu's door right on time.

Four suppressant bottles were neatly arranged on the table in front of Yin Lingzhu.

"Four bottles?" Yin Lingzhu looked at Ming Qingyun in surprise.

"My money was only enough to buy three. I can't afford more."

Her tone was heavy. She even turned out her clean pockets, using actions to show that she was tight on money.

Ming Qingyun found it a bit funny. She knew Yin Lingzhu had misunderstood her. "I have a buy-three-get-one-free deal here. The extra bottle is a gift for you."

Yin Lingzhu looked at her with half-belief, "You're just giving me five hundred thousand like that?"

Ming Qingyun nodded very seriously.

Joy surged in Yin Lingzhu's heart. Five hundred thousand, given for free.

But she quickly realized something was wrong.

"Why are you so good to me?" Yin Lingzhu asked in confusion, "Is there something here that you want?"

Under Yin Lingzhu's nervous gaze, Ming Qingyun shook her head.

"I consider you a friend. Being good to friends is very normal."

Ming Qingyun smiled gently, her eyes full of sincerity, without a trace of falseness.

Yin Lingzhu looked left and right but couldn't see any other intentions from her.

Anyway, she was currently alone with nothing worth coveting.

Thinking this way, Yin Lingzhu's heart settled down again.

But guilt slowly crept up in her heart.

Ming Qingyun was so good to her, yet she still had to doubt others.

She had gone too far.

Thinking this, the guilt in Yin Lingzhu's heart almost drowned her.

She stood up, wanting to apologize to Ming Qingyun.

Ming Qingyun was so good to her, yet she still doubted her.

Ming Qingyun seemed to see what Yin Lingzhu was thinking in her heart, and she also stood up.

"When you're away from home, having some vigilance is a good thing." Ming Qingyun smiled gently, looking like she didn't mind this matter at all.

Yin Lingzhu was moved to tears by her attitude.

The two chatted for a while before Ming Qingyun left.

Footnotes:

¹ **Susceptible period:** Also known as "heat" for Omegas or "rut" for Alphas—a biological cycle in the ABO universe where individuals experience intense physical and emotional needs, typically requiring suppressants or intimate contact to manage the symptoms.